identity

Service Description

Service ID: *"identity"*

Abstract
This document describes the `identity` service, version 1.0.0, produced by the Authentication core system of Arrowhead 5.2.2.

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1 Overview

This document describes the `identity` service, which provides authentication of systems: a system logs in with its credentials and obtains an identity token, which it presents to other systems; providers verify such tokens. It is produced by the Authentication system [1] in service version 1.0.0.

The rest of this document is organized as follows. In Section 2, we describe the abstract message operations provided by the service. In Section 3, we end the document by presenting the data types used by the mentioned operations. The concrete interfaces are specified in the HTTP/TLS/JSON IDD [2] and the MQTT/TLS/JSON IDD [3].

1.1 Significant Prior Art

Arrowhead 4.x authenticated systems only by X.509 certificates. The 5.x identity service adds credential-based login and identity tokens, used where certificates are not available or as a second factor.

1.2 How This Service Is Meant to Be Used

A system calls `identity-login` and sends the returned token as `Authorization: Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>`. Providers with the `outsourced` authentication policy call `identity-verify` to learn which system a token belongs to and whether it is a sysop. `identity-logout` ends the session, `identity-change-credentials` replaces the password.

1.3 Important Delimitations and Dependencies

Authentication keeps one session per system: a new login replaces the previous token of that system. In this workspace login, logout and credential change over HTTPS are accepted only with the client certificate of the same system, and every token is bound to the certificate it is used with (token-to-certificate binding). The service does not authorize anything.

2 Service Interface

This section describes the interfaces to the `identity` service. In particular, each subsection names an abstract operation, an input type and an output type, in that order. The input type is named inside parentheses, while the output type is preceded by a colon. Input and output types are only denoted when accepted or returned, respectively, by the interface in question.

All abstract data types named in this section are defined in Section 3.

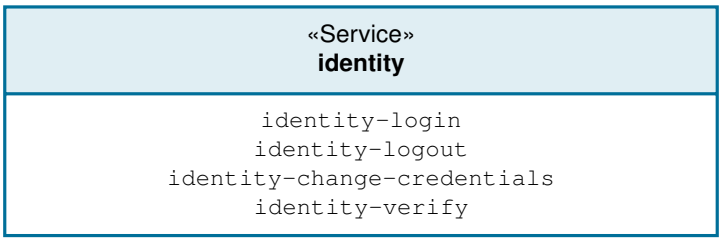


Figure 1: SysML-style block of the `identity` service and its operations.

The following interface operations are available.

2.1 operation identity-login (IdentityRequest) : IdentityLoginResponse

Checks the credentials and opens a session. Returns the identity token and its expiry (`identity.token.duration`, 300 s in the default configuration). A previous token of the system becomes invalid.

2.2 operation identity-logout (IdentityRequest)

Checks the credentials and closes the session of the system.

2.3 operation identity-change-credentials (IdentityChangeRequest)

Checks the current credentials and replaces them with the new ones.

2.4 operation identity-verify (Token) : IdentityVerifyResponse

Checks an identity token. Returns whether it is valid and, if so, the system, its sysop flag, login and expiry time. The caller must itself present a valid identity token (only `login`, `logout` and `change` are token-free).

3 Information Model

Here, all data objects that can be part of the `identity` service are listed in alphabetic order. Note that each subsection, which describes one type of object, begins with the *struct* keyword, which is used to denote a collection of named fields, each with its own data type. As a complement to the explicitly defined types in this section, there is also a list of implicit primitive types in Section 3.5, which are used to represent things like hashes and identifiers.

3.1 struct IdentityChangeRequest

Changes the credentials of the requesting system.

Field	Type	Description
systemName	Name	Name of the system, PascalCase (e.g. `TemperatureSensor`).
credentials	Map<String, String>	Credentials of the authentication method, for `PASSWORD` the key `password`.
newCredentials	Map<String, String>	The new credentials.

3.2 struct IdentityLoginResponse

The identity token issued at login.

Field	Type	Description
token	Token	The identity token, used as `Bearer IDENTITY-TOKEN//<token>`.
expirationTime	DateTime	UTC time when the identity token expires.

3.3 struct IdentityRequest

System name and credentials.

Field	Type	Description
systemName	Name	Name of the system, PascalCase (e.g. `TemperatureSensor`).
credentials	Map<String, String>	Credentials of the authentication method, for `PASSWORD` the key `password`.

3.4 struct IdentityVerifyResponse

Result of verifying an identity token.

Field	Type	Description
verified	Boolean	True when the token is valid.
systemName	Name	System the token belongs to.
sysop	Boolean	Whether that system is a system operator.
loginTime	DateTime	UTC time of the login.
expirationTime	DateTime	UTC time when the identity token expires.

3.5 Primitives

Types and structures mentioned throughout this document that are assumed to be available to implementations of this service. The concrete interpretations of each of these types and structures must be provided by any IDD document claiming to implement this service.

Type	Description
Boolean	One out of `true` or `false`.
DateTime	Pinpoints a specific moment in time (UTC).
Map	A set of key-value pairs.
Name	A string identifier that is intended to be both human and machine-readable.
String	A chain of characters.
Token	An opaque string used as credential.

4 References

[1] J. Delsing, “Authentication – System Description,” Eclipse Arrowhead, SysD 5.2.2, 2026, authentication/documentation/v5.2.2/Authentication-v5.2.2-SysD.pdf.

[2] ——, “identity HTTP/TLS/JSON – Interface Design Description (Authentication),” Eclipse Arrowhead, IDD 5.2.2, 2026, authentication-v5.2.2-identity-HTTP-IDD.pdf.

[3] ——, “identity MQTT/TLS/JSON – Interface Design Description (Authentication),” Eclipse Arrowhead, IDD 5.2.2, 2026, authentication-v5.2.2-identity-MQTT-IDD.pdf.

5 Revision History

5.1 Amendments

No.	Date	Version	Subject of Amendments	Author
1	2026-10-22	5.2.2	Document created from the Arrowhead LaTeX templates for the 5.2.2 Java Spring implementation, including the local extensions of this workspace.	Jerker Delsing

5.2 Quality Assurance

No.	Date	Version	Approved by
1		5.2.2	